

POLYDRUG USE AND DRIVING

Polydrug use is the mixing or taking of more than one type of drug. Mixing alcohol, cannabis, or other drugs can produce effects greater than any drug on its own. It can include alcohol, cannabis, illegal drugs, prescription drugs, over-the-counter medicines, and other substances such as nonregulated drugs and inhalants. Polydrug use is the most common impairment involved in fatal crashes.

Effects of polydrug use vary from person to person and depend on the drug's quantity, frequency of use, and how they're taken. Polydrug use can lead to increased probability of overdose, mental health troubles, risky behavior, serious injuries, and crashes.

FATIGUE AND DROWSY DRIVING

Fatigue is caused by physical or mental strain, repetitive tasks, illness, or lack of sleep. Like alcohol and drugs, fatigue impairs your vision and judgment.

Drowsy driving affects your alertness, attention, reaction time, judgment, and decision-making capabilities. When you drive fatigued, you risk falling asleep behind the wheel and causing a crash involving injuries or fatalities.

Here are some signs of fatigue. **Pull over and rest if you are:**

- Having difficulty focusing, or you can't remember driving the last few miles.
- Blinking frequently or have heavy eyelids.
- Having trouble keeping your head up.
- Missing exits or traffic signs.
- Feeling restless, irritable, or aggressive.
- Drifting from your lane, swerving, tailgating, and/or hitting rumble strips.

